WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

WEEK 43 · October 23rd, 2026

MARKET OVERVIEW

Russian seaborne crude loadings experienced a noticeable lull heading into mid-October, largely driven by a temporary operational pause at the Baltic terminal of Primorsk. Marine traffic data and satellite observations pointed to several days of empty berths as local maintenance work brought loading activity to a brief standstill, pulling national outbound volumes down to their lowest weekly levels since early spring. While shipments from the Black Sea hub of Novorossiysk held up well and activity across the Baltic showed signs of life by the weekend, the interruption dragged both four-week export averages and overall weekly revenues down to multi-week lows. Even with strong realised pricing for Pacific grades like ESPO cushioning the blow, weaker volumes and softer Urals benchmarks combined to put a clear dent in Moscow's immediate export earnings.

Beneath these short-term terminal bottlenecks lies a more intricate tug-of-war between refining disruptions and genuine supply constraints. Ukrainian drone strikes against domestic processing sites resumed over the past week, leaving a primary crude distillation unit damaged at Ryazan and causing an industrial fire in western Siberia. While damaging local refineries often forces unrefined crude directly into the seaborne export pipeline, Russia's ability to ramp up foreign deliveries is increasingly running into an upstream ceiling. Nationwide crude extraction slipped in September to roughly eight and a half million barrels daily, the lowest monthly mark recorded in over six years, marking a tenth straight month of declining production that naturally puts a tighter cap on how much crude can make its way to the water.

At the same time, commercial players are closely watching how evolving political signals from Washington might reshape the flow of barrels into Asia. Recent American policy manoeuvres, including the shelving of proposed congressional sanctions and discussions aimed at steering shadow vessels back into the commercial mainstream, have noticeably eased tariff anxieties for key buyers in India. Although a sizable volume of oil at sea remains tied up in mid-voyage lightering zones off Singapore and the Russian Far East, major consumers across India and China continue to absorb the lion's share of available supply.

With geopolitical talks lingering in the background and buyers keeping a close eye on delivery schedules, market participants are watching to see whether this brief lull in shipments quickly gives way to a fresh surge of Asian bound liftings.

DRY BULK | BDI: 2,660 ▲5.93% (w-o-w)

The dry bulk sector demonstrated encouraging resilience, led by an upbeat performance across the larger vessel categories that helped lift the Baltic Exchange's dry bulk freight index for a third consecutive session by 3.4% to reach 2,660 points. Leading this upward drive, the Capesize index climbed for a third straight day with a surge to 3,791 points, finding support from positive longer-term fundamentals even as West African iron ore shipments from the advancing Simandou development are anticipated to claim approximately 15% of regional Capesize exports during the third quarter without immediately altering tonne-mile dynamics.

Smaller segments experienced steady to divergent outcomes, with the Supramax index edging up to 1,887 points, while the Panamax sector faced moderate downward pressure, declining to settle at 2,109 points. A steadying tone for dry bulk, buoyed by the renewed strength of heavy-cargo carriers and selective support across the broader fleet.

Segment Highlights

Capesize: Capesize experienced some weakness this week as overall rates dropped amid expanding ballast tonnage, though late-week paper improvements sparked a solid rebound in West Australia and Brazil. Spot earnings mirrored this late-week divergence, with E.C. South America surging to US$67,420's per day and Pacific R/V rebounding to US$37,120's, while T/A softened to US$30,530's. Firm Australian coal enquiry and healthy C5 demand should help establish a near-term floor.

Panamax / Kamsarmax: Panamax softened further this week as sluggish USG grain appetite and Atlantic tonnage accumulation outweighed firmer fixtures and typhoon-related prompt demand in the Pacific. Reflecting this disparity, Transpacific and South Asian runs held relatively stable while longer-haul business suffered, leaving Indonesian R/V slightly higher at US$19,850's and Fronthaul returns slipping to US$30,000's per day. Australian coal flows and weather disruptions around Indonesia should lend ongoing support to the East, but discounted November FFA paper will maintain downward pressure in the Atlantic.

Supramax / Ultramax: Supramax drew steady support from the East this week, where tighter prompt vessel availability around Indonesia and route-specific stem concentrations lifted NOPAC and Indo-India trades by over 4%. Atlantic activity showed mixed momentum as mild USG gains were offset by softer West African F/H, settling Pacific-India earnings up at US$21,325's while B/H runs eased marginally to US$16,905's.

Handysize: Handysize displayed a mixed tone this week, with quiet trading and subdued inquiry in the USG alongside continuing rate improvements across the South Atlantic. Balanced fundamentals in the Mediterranean and a tight tonnage supply against steady inquiries in the Pacific helped insulate spot levels, nudging Inter-Pacific returns up to US$17,095's while T/A rates softened to US$18,400's. Healthy South Atlantic demand should maintain a dependable floor.

Baltic Dry Indices

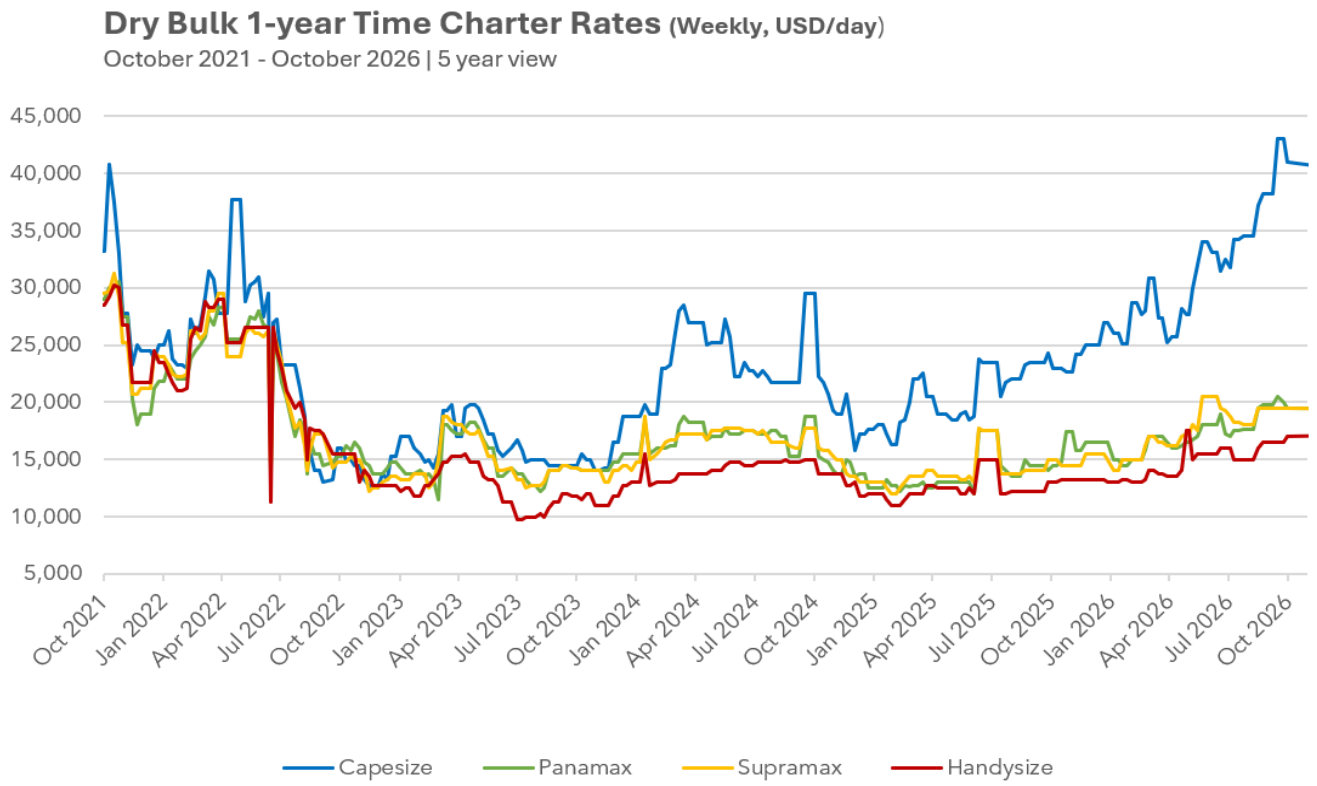
BDI	BCI	BPI	BSI	BHSI
2,660	**3,791**	**2,109**	**1,887**	**1,020**
WoW: +5.93%	WoW: +16.68%	WoW: -8.86%	WoW: +1.18%	WoW: +0.89%
YoY: +33.60%	YoY: +32.04%	YoY: +9.62%	YoY: +37.84%	YoY: +16.17%

Vessel Value (USD Million)

TYPE	DWT	NB CONTRACT	NB PROMPT	5 YRS	10 YRS	15 YRS
CAPESIZE	180,000	$76M	$82M	$71M	$56M (E)	$35M
KAMSARMAX	82,000	$38M	$45M	$38M	$31M (E)	$25M
ULTRAMAX	64,000	$35M	$44M	$38M (E)	$29M	$19M
HANDY	38,000	$31M	$37M	$29M	$23M	$18M

Sale & Purchase — Reported Fixtures

VESSEL	TYPE	DWT	YEAR / BUILT	PRICE (USD M)	BUYER
WEI HE	PMAX	79,440	2012 / CHINA	16.0	CHINESE BUYERS
GUO DIAN 18	PMAX	72,272	1997 / JAPAN	6.5	UNDISCLOSED
YASA UNSAL SUNAR	SMAX	55,526	2007 / JAPAN	15.0	UNDISCLOSED
JIN XING	SMAX	55,496	2007 / JAPAN	14.6	HENG FA SHIPPING
STELLAR ISABELA	HANDY	37,993	2017 / JAPAN	25.5	UNDISCLOSED



SEGMENT (AVG)	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026 YTD
CAPESIZE	$22,350	$16,300	$22,715	$21,650	$41,000
PANAMAX	$20,550	$14,725	$16,355	$14,385	$19,450
SUPRAMAX	$20,450	$14,570	$16,300	$14,250	$19,500
HANDY	$20,770	$12,300	$13,875	$12,655	$17,000

TANKERS | BDTI: 7,152 ▼-7.44% (w-o-w)

Beyond baseline voyage tariffs, unprecedented operational friction and regulatory clampdowns are reshaping buyer behavior toward short-haul certainty. Delays in STS transfers outside the Strait of Hormuz, exacerbated by drone strikes, have propelled demurrage charges to US$1 million daily—adding approximately US$0.50 per barrel for each idle day on a laden VLCC—while war-risk insurance premiums have soared to 8% of vessel value, adding another US$9 to US$10 million. These extreme logistics costs have even driven Canadian Trans Mountain pipeline export freight on smaller Aframaxes up to US$30 per barrel, mirroring larger carrier classes and prompting Chinese state firms to quickly secure all November-loading Russian ESPO stems ahead of independent refiners.

Maritime regulatory enforcement has expanded under Operation Economic Outcast, with the U.S. Treasury blacklisting 9 vessels alongside service facilitators, including the law firm Karnakis & Karnakis, fleet manager Roxette Maritime Shipping, Amigoz Singapore, and Dubai-based Whales Shipping Line for enabling illicit commodity flows. The tanker landscape continues to fragment into shorter, highly localized voyages under historic freight costs.

Segment Highlights

VLCC: East VLCC rates softened as cargo requirements through late October were largely cleared during the preceding surge, prompting charterers to drip-feed stems against record freight burdens. MEG/China fell to WS1208 and trips from Gulf of Oman slipped to WS620 mark. In the Atlantic, trips from WAFR fell some 140 points to WS556.

Suezmax: West African rates tumbled as an influx of Atlantic tonnage from muted Fujairah business, and muted cargo inquiries weighed heavily on fixing sentiment. 130,000mt Nigeria/UKC fell 170 points closing at WS731 mark. USG/UKC trips also saw similar dips, dropping to WS666 on Friday.

Aframax: MEG rates held resilient with a marginal gain, decoupling from larger crude segments as vessel exclusions driven by Persian Gulf security risks kept effective regional capacity sharply constrained. The Mediterranean, however, looks poised to firm further on steady liftings ex-Sidi Kerir and Port Said STS operations absorbing early November tonnage as rates climbed 86 points to WS810's.

LR1 / LR2: MEG LR2 rates climbed this week as expanding attacks on vessels transiting the Strait fuelled fears of falling product export volumes alongside convoluted STS operations off Oman. TC1 climbed to WS1,075 mark while in LR1 segment, TC5 closed higher at WS1,105.

MR: in the Far East MR market, freight rates closed on a strong note, buoyed by solid product exports from East Asia. In the MEG, trips to E. Africa saw steady gain climbing to WS896. Similarly in the TC14, USG/UKC rose to WS399.

Baltic Tanker Indices

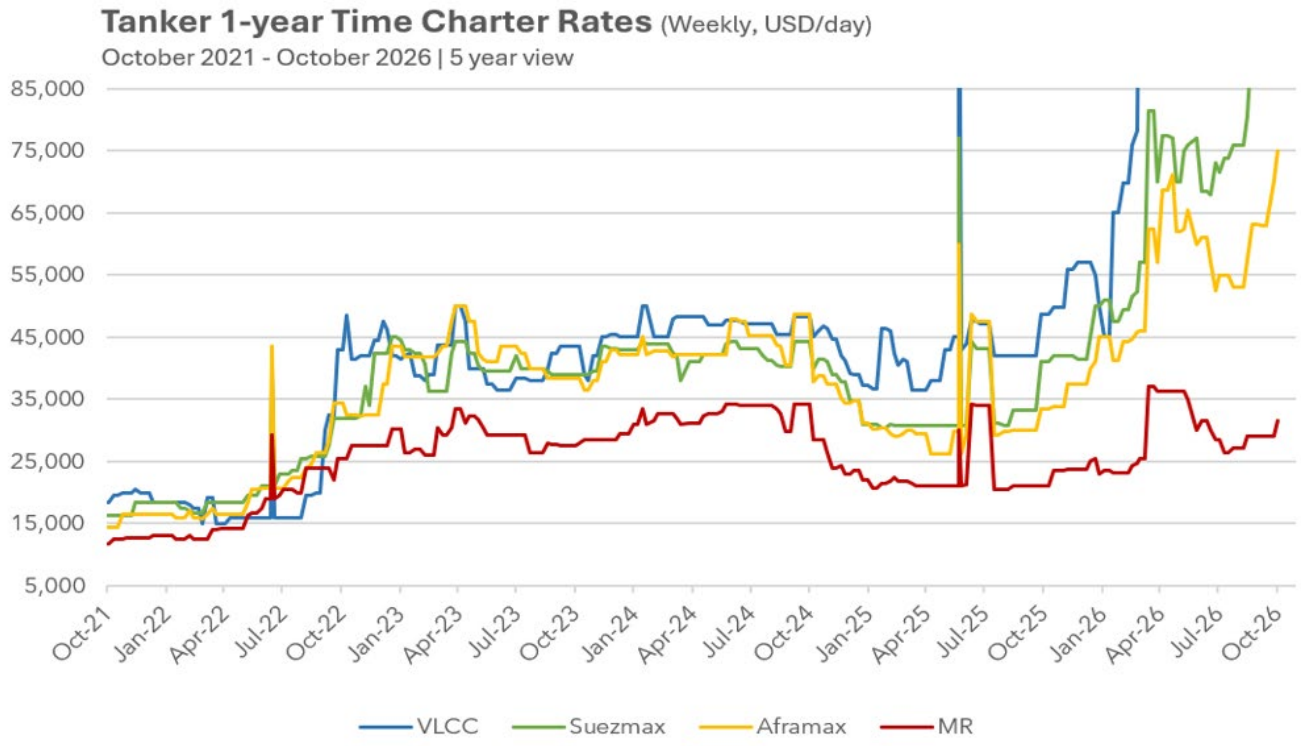
BDTI	BCTI
7,152	2,856
WoW: -7.44%	WoW: +13.24%
YoY: +479.58%	YoY: +344.86%

Vessel Values (USD Million)

TYPE	DWT	NB CONTRACT	NB PROMPT	5 YRS	10 YRS	15 YRS
VLCC	310,000	$130M	$175M	$141M (E)	$112M (E)	$64M
SUEZMAX	160,000	$90M	$115M	$95M (E)	$85M (E)	$56M
AFRAMAX	115,000	$78M	$95M	$80M (E)	$70M (E)	$51M
LR1	73,000	$67M	$74M	$64M (E)	$55M (E)	$33M
MR	51,000	$51M	$60M	$49M (E)	$40M (E)	$30M

Sale & Purchase — Reported Fixtures

VESSEL	TYPE	DWT	YEAR / BUILT	PRICE (USD)	BUYER
ACHILLEAS	SUEZ	157,883	2010 / S. KOREA	98.0	UNDISCLOSED
ZOUZOU N.	SUEZ	149,991	2010 / CHINA	103.0	UNDISCLOSED
AEGEAN HARMONY	AFRA	115,824	2007 / S. KOREA	55.0	UNDISCLOSED
PRIVE ANGEL	MR	51,246	2008 / S. KOREA	24.5	UNDISCLOSED
HANSA OSLO	MR	51,215	2007 / S. KOREA	20.0	UNDISCLOSED
MATRAH	MR	51,021	2008 / S. KOREA	18.5	UNDISCLOSED
HIGH FIDELITY	MR	49,990	2014 / VIETNAM	14.0	D'AMICO INTERNATIONAL
SEYCHELLES PROGRESS	MR	37,557	2005 / GERMANY	13.65	UNDISCLOSED
SAKURA SHUCHI	PROD / CHEM	19,969	2006 / JAPAN	13.0	UNDISCLOSED



SEGMENT (AVG)	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026 YTD
VLCC	$25,215	$41,550	$45,950	$45,075	$178,500
SUEZMAX	$25,645	$40,625	$41,175	$35,685	$132,000
AFRAMAX	$24,400	$41,850	$41,950	$33,050	$75,000
MR	$20,050	$28,800	$30,750	$23,000	$31,500

CONTAINERS

Global container shipping market maintained a steady, range-bound posture this week as the SCFI index edged up to close at 3,681.34 points. In Europe and the Mediterranean, rates posted modest gains as ocean carriers actively defended spot baselines ahead of upcoming 2027 contract renewals, supported by MSC introducing fresh Freight All Kinds rate benchmarks effective October 19th; however, the accelerating transition of mainline services back to the Suez Canal is progressively shortening sailing distances and expanding effective capacity, prompting BIMCO to caution that container fleet growth in 2027 will comfortably outpace cargo volume expansion as Cape of Good Hope diversions unwind.

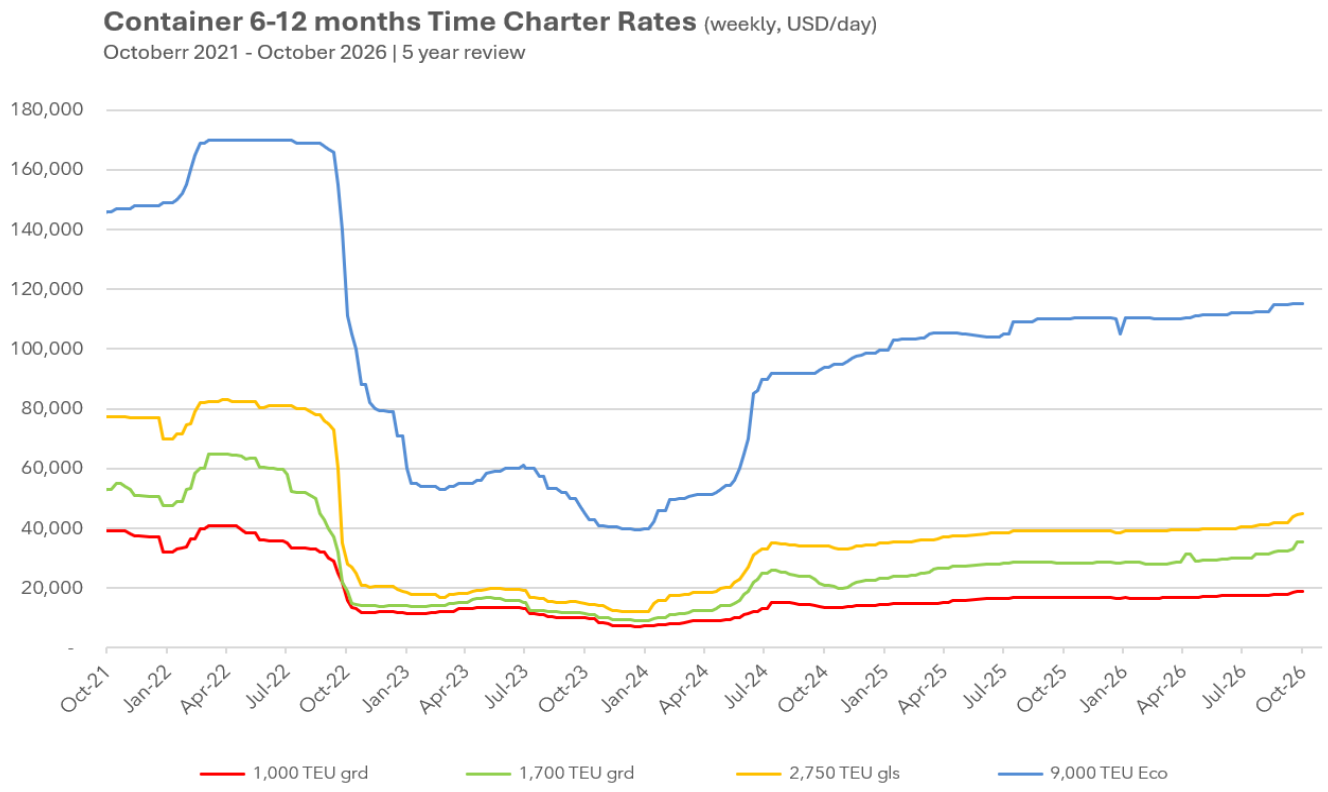
Regional Middle Eastern trades registered a slight rate increase, reflecting persistent maritime risks alongside ongoing logistics adaptations designed to navigate the embattled Strait of Hormuz. Meanwhile, Iraq's national maritime carrier marked a historic development by deploying the 902 TEU Basrah on an eight-day shuttle linking Jebel Ali with Umm Qasr—representing the state line's first scheduled Gulf operation since the mid-1960s—to establish a dedicated maritime conduit for stranded volumes. This direct marine shuttle serves to complement, rather than replace, the extensive multimodal networks developed during the regional disruption, which have seen Jordan's Red Sea gateway of Aqaba handle 37,182 Iraq-bound transit containers during the first seven months of 2026—a 933% surge over the 3,599 containers moved during the same period last year—alongside integrated overland truck connections arranged by Maersk, CMA CGM, and Hapag-Lloyd to keep commercial imports moving.

Vessel Values (USD Million)

SIZE (TEU)	TYPE	NB CONTRACT	NB PROMPT	5 YRS	10 YRS	15 YRS
900 – 1,200	Geared	$25M	$29M	$23M	$18M	$12M
1,600 – 1,850	Gearless	$32M	$38M	$30M (E)	$25M (E)	$18M
2,700 – 2,900	Gearless	$44M	$46M	$40M	$35M	$26M
5,100 – 5,300	Gearless	$55M	$79M	$64M	—	$39M

Sale & Purchase — Reported Fixtures

VESSEL	TYPE	TEU	YEAR / BUILT	PRICE (USD M)	BUYER
EVRIDIKI G	SUB PMAX	2,556	2001 / S. KOREA	26.0	MSC CROCIERCE SA
NORDMAAS	FEEDER	1,774	2019 / CHINA	35.0	UNDISCLOSED



SEGMENT (AVG)	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026 YTD
1000 TEU	$29,580	$10,950	$11,900	$16,150	$18,750
1,700 TEU	$44,585	$13,050	$18,580	$27,325	$35,500
2,750 TEU	$63,500	$16,450	$27,475	$37,900	$45,000
9,000 TEU	$145,525	$51,700	$75,775	$107,025	$115,250

SHIP RECYCLING

Current Market Snapshot (USD / LDT)

DESTINATION	TANKERS	BULKERS	GENERAL CARGO	CONTAINERS	OUTLOOK / SENTIMENTS
ALANG, INDIA	$490–500	$480–490	$440–450	$540–550	STABLE /
CHATTOGRAM, BANGLADESH	$510 - 520	$490–500	$480–490	$560–570	STABLE /
GADDANI, PAKISTAN	$510–520	$490–500	$480–490	$530–540	STABLE /
ALIAGA, TURKEY*	$320–330	$310–320	$290–300	$340–350	STABLE /

** Turkey prices for non-EU ships. EU vessels approx. US$20–30/ton less.*

All prices are USD per light displacement tonnage (long ton), net prices offered by recycling yards. Premiums apply based on spares quality, non-ferrous content, bunkers, cargo history, and maintenance. Basis simple Japanese/Korean-built tonnages.

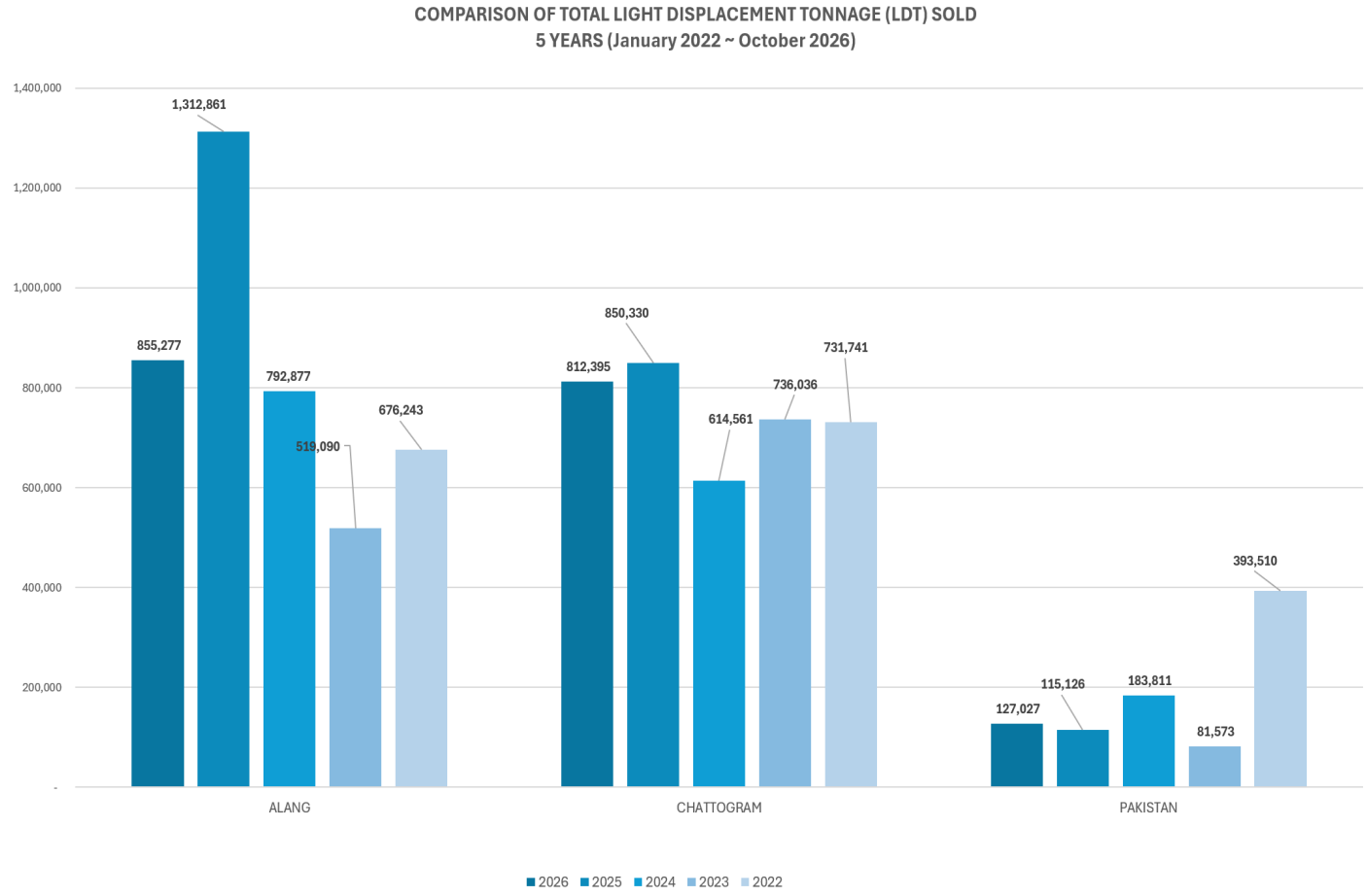
- *All prices are USD per light displacement tonnage in the long ton.*
- *The prices reported are net prices offered by the recycling yards.*
- *Prices quoted are basis simple Japanese / Korean-built tonnages trading units. Premiums are paid on top of the above-quoted prices based on quality & quality of Spares, Non-Fe., bunkers, cargo history, and maintenance.*

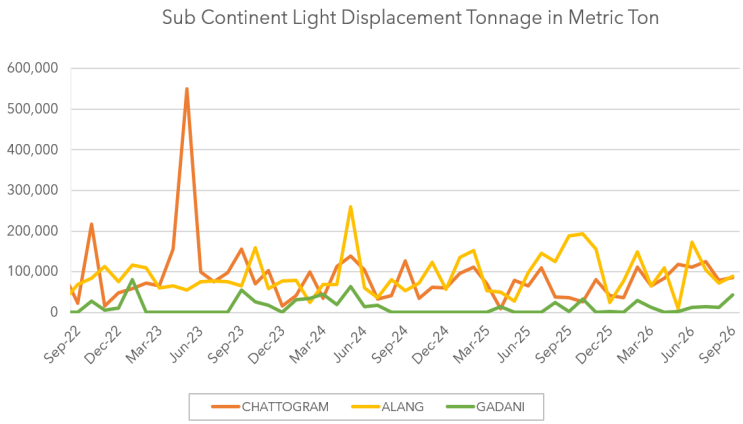
5-Year Historical Average Prices (Week 43)

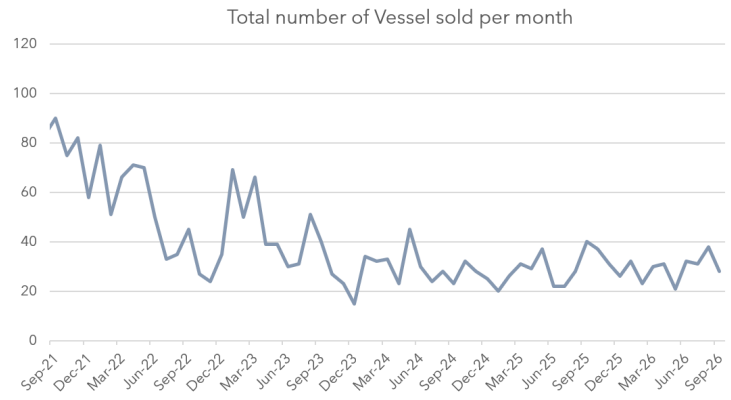
DESTINATION	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
ALANG, INDIA	600	600	540	470	390
CHATTOGRAM, BANGLADESH	610	600	480	460	400
GADDANI, PAKISTAN	600	580	510	480	420
ALIAGA, TURKEY	300	320	300	360	280

Reported Sales

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	YEAR / BUILT	PRICE (US/LDT)	COMMENTS
KPP 02 / KPP 03	TANKER	1,446 / 1,306	-	UNDISCLOSED	DELIVERED CHATTOGRAM
LIAN YI DA 2 HAO	BULKER	5,560	1998 / JAPAN	512	DELIVERED CHATTOGRAM
AFFINIS	REEFER	2,919	1997 / SPAIN	UNDISCLOSED	AS IS MAURITIUS


COMPARISON OF TOTAL LIGHT DISPLACEMENT TONNAGE (LDT) SOLD
5 YEARS (January 2022 ~ October 2026)
1,400,000
1,200,000
1,000,000
800,000
600,000
400,000
200,000
-
855,277
1,312,861
792,877
519,090
676,243
812,395
850,330
614,561
736,036
731,741
127,027
115,126
183,811
81,573
393,510
ALANG
CHATTOGRAM
PAKISTAN
2026 2025 2024 2023 2022


Sub Continent Light Displacement Tonnage in Metric Ton
600,000
500,000
400,000
300,000
200,000
100,000
0
Sep-22
Dec-22
Mar-23
Jun-23
Sep-23
Dec-23
Mar-24
Jun-24
Sep-24
Dec-24
Mar-25
Jun-25
Sep-25
Dec-25
Mar-26
Jun-26
Sep-26
CHATTOGRAM
ALANG
GADANI


Total number of Vessel sold per month
120
100
80
60
40
20
0
Sep-21
Dec-21
Mar-22
Jun-22
Sep-22
Dec-22
Mar-23
Jun-23
Sep-23
Dec-23
Mar-24
Jun-24
Sep-24
Dec-24
Mar-25
Jun-25
Sep-25
Dec-25
Mar-26
Jun-26
Sep-26

Market Insights

Alang, India: Alang observed a noticeably calmer rhythm, as regional celebrations and seasonal holidays prompted yard owners and labor teams to briefly pause. Even with the holiday slowdown, the broader market tone remains resilient and well-anchored, cushioned by healthy domestic steel absorption and an enduring requirement for secondary re-rollable melting scrap. While cash buyers remain ready to negotiate, fresh deal flow continues to feel the pinch of a tight international supply pipeline, leaving waterfront yards competing for an unusually sparse inflow of viable candidates.

Recent forecasts reaffirm the country's position as a standout economic performer, with annual growth projections being revised higher toward healthy levels despite central monetary authorities remaining cautious about building inflationary pressures.

Alang Anchorage & Beaching Position — October 2026

VESSEL	TYPE	LDT	ARRIVAL	BEACHING
AFFINIS	REEFER	2,920	23.10.2026	AWAITING
INZHENER VESHNYAKOV	GENERAL CARGO	4,200	23.10.2026	AWAITING
INZHENER TRUBIN	GENERAL CARGO	4,000	17.10.2026	24.10.2026
MODESTE	TANKER	8,766	14.10.2026	18.10.2026
KADIJA	GENERAL CARGO	4,815	13.10.2026	15.10.2026
KANO	LNG	31,300	10.10.2026	15.10.2026
MAYMEI	TANKER	9,877	09.10.2026	11.10.2026
ENSIEY	BULKER	9,886	06.10.2026	09.10.2026
EVS	FISHING	1,226	05.10.2026	09.10.2026
RIGHT	TANKER	10,088	04.10.2026	07.10.2026

Chattogram, Bangladesh: Chattogram displayed a subdued tone, with prevailing softness in overall trading even as underlying appetite among remains exceptionally keen. Buyers continue to comb international lists in search of workable candidates. However, this desire to buy is heavily tempered by commercial prudence, leading buyers to approach negotiations cautiously. With levels staying elevated and fewer workable vessels surfacing, buyers prefer to wait for viable candidates that match their budgets.

While national foreign exchange reserves have shown stability and import financing conditions have improved through regular banking channels, domestic businesses remain mindful of lingering inflationary pressures and high borrowing costs. As regional rebar producers keep raw material procurement closely aligned with immediate mill consumption, yards are choosing to protect their profit margins by avoiding speculative bidding.

Chattogram Anchorage & Beaching Position — October 2026

VESSEL	TYPE	LDT	ARRIVAL	BEACHING
UNIORDER	BULKER	7,078	15.10.2026	AWAITING
GREEN	TANKER	8,274	14.10.2026	AWAITING
K.P.P.02	TANKER	1,288	12.10.2026	16.10.2026
V.L.15	TANKER	1,427	10.10.2026	16.10.2026
K.P.P03	TANKER	1,335	11.10.2026	15.10.2026
PACIFIC LEADER	GENERAL CARGO	911	06.10.2026	15.10.2026
PETROVA	TANKER	2,397	03.10.2026	03.10.2026
HAKU	ROPAX	11,304	28.09.2026	03.10.2026
B-LPG SOPHIA	LPG	3,420	LAID UP AT CHATTOGRAM	01.102026
PHIL	BARGE	3,543	28.09.2026	01.10.2026
MERC	TUG	489	28.09.2026	01.10.2026

Gaddani, Pakistan: Gadani's recycling market found support from firmer domestic steel plate prices, although buying remained cautious. Pakistan's closure of its border with Iran was welcomed by recyclers, who expect restrictions on cheap, reportedly smuggled Iranian steel to ease pressure on local prices. Improved sentiment encouraged breakers to pursue suitable vessels, but activity along the waterfront remained subdued as buyers maintained disciplined offers. Enquiry continued for competitively priced tonnage, though the gap between sellers' expectations and buyers' willingness to offer kept transaction volumes in check.

Beyond the beaches, the regional business atmosphere is contending with fresh cross-border friction following the sudden suspension of commercial trade with neighbouring Iran. The immediate closure of the Gabd-Rimdan and Taftan border corridors has stranded hundreds of freight trucks, sparking widespread concern among commercial chambers over potential spikes in industrial energy costs and disruptions to vital liquefied petroleum gas inflows. These ongoing transport issues across Balochistan have prompted local manufacturers and re-rolling mills to monitor their overheads and input expenses with heightened vigilance.

Gaddani Anchorage & Beaching Position — October 2026

VESSEL	TYPE	LDT	ARRIVAL	BEACHING
MAESTRO	BULKER	5,143	10.10.2026	14.10.2026
PORTLAND 11	BULKER	7,381	05.10.2026	09.10.2026
LINA F	BULKER	5,688	28.09.2026	02.10.2026

Aliaga, Turkey: Aliaga saw another steady week, with price benchmarks holding largely unchanged. The persistent depreciation of the Turkish lira keeps buyers mindful of their operating margins and unwilling to bid aggressively on fresh tonnage. This mirrors wider domestic financial developments, with the central bank's recent decision to lower its benchmark interest rate by 100 basis points down to 36% following four consecutive months of cooling annual inflation. While this modest borrowing relief is a welcome development for local businesses, manufacturing demand and finished steel consumption remain soft across the country, especially with elevated energy expenses keeping operational overhead high.

TIDE DATES 2026 | **Chattogram**: 25 ~28 October | 07 ~ 10 November

Alang: 25 October ~ 01 November | 07 ~ 14 November

SUB-CONTINENT & TURKEY SCRAP MARKETS

India: The imported containerised market held steady this week, with trading paused as major local festival holidays and weak finished-steel demand kept buyers firmly on the sidelines. UK-origin shredded scrap offers were indicated at US$400–405/t CFR Nhava Sheva against buyer bids of US$390–395/t CFR, leaving a notable price disparity unbridged. Meanwhile, HMS 80:20 indications circulated at US$365–370/t CFR against lower bids of US$355–360/t CFR, resulting in no confirmed deals across the session.

Pakistan: Imported scrap values strengthened following acute regional supply disruptions caused by the sinking of a vessel carrying approximately 30,000 t of UAE material. In response, UK and EU shredded scrap offers advanced to US$420–422/t CFR Qasim, supported by a prompt UK shredded transaction concluded at US$425/t CFR on Saturday. With available offers thinning rapidly, a Karachi-based steelmaker projects prices could climb a further US$5–10/t amid strengthening replacement demand from Europe and the UK.

Bangladesh: Imported scrap offers maintained a firm tone, driven by rising November Ocean freight rates that lifted Singapore-origin PNS quotes to US$430–435/t CFR Chattogram, while vessel shortages eliminated Malaysian offers entirely. UK shredded indications held at US$408–410/t CFR against HMS levels of US$370–375/t CFR, and Australian containerised shredded stood at US$415/t CFR Chattogram. However, high domestic finished-steel inventories continued to temper buying interest, preventing mills from chasing higher replacement numbers.

Turkiye: Deep-sea import benchmarks remained unchanged, with HMS 80:20 holding flat at US$395/t CFR amid muted transaction activity and sparse European and US offerings. Sluggish rebar sales and persistent price pressure on finished steel have left mills fiercely resistant to accepting higher scrap costs or volatile ocean freight surcharges. Consequently, buyers maintained a cautious procurement stance, firmly refusing to counter above US$385/t CFR for European-origin material under current market dynamics.

COMMODITIES, BUNKERS & RATES

Commodities Focus

Copper led base metals lower this week as a selloff in AI-related stocks weakened sentiment and raised concerns that slower spending on data centres and power grids could dampen demand. Supply disruptions drew less attention, despite threatened strike action at Canada's Highland Valley copper mine and mounting labour tensions across South America. Nickel held up better as traders weighed prospects of tighter Indonesian supply. Chinese producers operating in Indonesia pledged to reduce mixed hydroxide precipitate output by around 20%, potentially tightening supplies of the battery intermediate and providing some support against the broader retreat in risk appetite across metals markets.

Aluminium traded just above US$3,000 per tonne in London, near multi-month lows, as strong Asian supply outweighed persistent Gulf disruptions. Chinese smelters ran close to peak capacity, with September exports rising 25.9% year-on-year to a three-month high. Indonesian shipments exceeded 150,000 tonnes in August, further easing supply concerns. Gulf production remained constrained, with Emirates Global Aluminium restoring only a quarter of the reduction cells at its Al Taweelah smelter following conflict-related disruption. Meanwhile, Rio Tinto's agreement to extend operations at Tasmania's Bell Bay plant through 2031 provided longer-term support for Western aluminium supply.

Iron ore futures retreated toward CNY 670 per ton, matching a four-year trough after China Mineral Resources Group verbally advised domestic steelmakers that it had secured an updated supply arrangement with Rio Tinto, successfully resolving prior delivery disputes. The settlement arrives amidst an influx of seaborne material, with total global iron ore loadings rising by 3.89 million tons w-o-w to 34.77 million tons for the week ending October 18, propelled by Australia and Brazil expanding combined export volumes by 4.79 million tons to 29.82 million tons.

Iron Ore

COMMODITY (USD/MT)	GRADE	THIS WEEK	LAST WEEK	LAST YEAR	WoW	YoY
Iron Ore Lumps, CNF Rizhao	Fe 64/63% (S. Africa)	$101	$101	$112	0%	-9.82%
Iron Ore Fines, CNF Qingdao	Fe 62.5% (Brazil)	$91	$91	$102	0%	-10.78%

Industrial Metal Rates

INDEX	UNITS	PRICE	CHANGE	% CHANGE	CONTRACT
Copper (Comex)	USD / lb.	651.80	+12.00	+1.88%	DEC 2026
3Mo Copper (LME)	USD / MT	14,078.00	-278.00	-1.94%	N/A
3Mo Aluminium (LME)	USD / MT	3,009.50	-32.00	-1.05%	N/A
3Mo Zinc (LME)	USD / MT	3,671.00	-84.00	-2.24%	N/A
3Mo Tin (LME)	USD / MT	50,089.00	-1,159.00	-2.26%	N/A

Crude Oil & Natural Gas

INDEX	UNITS	PRICE	CHANGE	% CHANGE	CONTRACT
WTI Crude Oil (Nymex)	USD / bbl.	102.98	+3.51	+3.53%	DEC 2026
Brent Crude (ICE)	USD / bbl.	117.16	+3.99	+3.53%	DEC 2026
Crude Oil (Tokyo)	JPY / kl	109,800.00	+1,910.00	+1.77%	OCT 2026
Natural Gas (Nymex)	USD / MMBtu	2.65	-0.14	-5.08%	NOV 2026

** All rates at C.O.B. London time, October 23rd, 2026*

Exchange Rates

CURRENCY PAIR	OCTOBER 23	OCTOBER 16	WoW %
USD / CNY (China)	6.67	6.69	+0.30%
USD / BDT (Bangladesh)	123.64	123.03	-0.50%
USD / INR (India)	94.74	94.80	+0.06%
USD / PKR (Pakistan)	276.99	276.78	-0.08%
USD / TRY (Turkey)	49.63	49.41	-0.45%

Bunker Prices (USD / ton)

PORT	VLSFO (0.5%)	HSFO (3.5%)	MGO (0.1%)
SINGAPORE	$940	$879	$1334
HONG KONG	$963	$952	$1349
FUJAIRAH	$974	$748	$1750
ROTTERDAM	$761	$677	$1437
HOUSTON	$800	$593	$1430

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